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System and apparatus for the control of battery energy storage systems

Abstract

A battery energy storage system is disclosed that receives energy from an electrical grid and supplies electrical energy to one or more microgrids. The battery energy storage system comprises a power conversion system arranged to charge a battery with the energy from the electrical grid and discharge the battery to supply electrical energy to the one or more microgrids. An energy control system controller communicatively coupled to the power conversion system manages the energy drawn from the electrical grid to charge the battery and to manage the energy discharged from the battery to supply electrical energy to the one or more microgrids.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This disclosure is generally directed to energy storage systems. More specifically, it relates to a system and apparatus for the control of battery energy storage systems.

BACKGROUND

(2) Currently, most electric power is generated by large, centralized power plants, such as nuclear

powerplants, hydroelectric plants, and fossil fuel powered plants. These large facilities frequently generate power using non-renewable sources of energy, such as coal or gas. Such power plants commonly have good economies of scale however due to various economic and operational reasons may not provide all of the power required to service the loads of the electrical grid services by the centralized power plant. For example, such as increased load at certain times of the day, aging outside plant and environmental impacts provided by seasonal effects. Energy storage systems having stored generated power may be connected at a power plant, substation, transmission line or at a customer site to selectively use stored energy to supplement or provide all the power required by the grid, thereby preventing service interruptions.

(3) Energy storage systems employ chemical energy storage batteries that chemically store energy such as for example a lithium ion (LiON) batteries, lead acid batteries (Pb), or sodium-sulfur (NAS) batteries. However, a conventional energy storage system may not be able to manage the power requirements of an area such as adjacent microgrids or buildings in an integrated manner. For example, a microgrid or building directly managed by an energy storage system with the power state of an adjacent building or microgrid powered by another energy storage system. This becomes further problematic when the adjacent microgrids or buildings have different peak control timings, different power generation plans and are required to control different power demands and supply states.

(4) The present disclosure describes an energy storage system that ensures the safe and reliable operation of an energy storage system while simultaneously delivering multiple use cases for managing the power requirements of adjacent areas of a power grid serviced by one or more energy storage systems.

SUMMARY

(5) This disclosure relates to a system and apparatus for the control of battery energy storage systems.

(6) In a first embodiment a battery energy storage system is disclosed that receives energy from an electrical grid and supplies electrical energy to one or more microgrids. The battery energy storage system comprises a power conversion system arranged to charge a battery with the energy from the electrical grid and discharge the battery to supply electrical energy to the one or more microgrids. An energy control system controller communicatively coupled to the power conversion system manages the energy drawn from the electrical grid to charge the battery and to manage the energy discharged from the battery to supply electrical energy to the one or more microgrids.

(7) In a second embodiment an apparatus is disclosed for receiving energy from an electrical grid and for supplying electrical energy to one or more microgrids. The apparatus comprising, an energy control system processor and an energy control system memory coupled to the energy control system processor. A power conversion system is arranged to charge a battery with the energy from the electrical grid and discharge the battery to supply electrical energy to the one or more microgrids. An energy control system controller stored in the energy control system memory is executed by the energy control system processor that manages the energy drawn from the electrical grid to charge the battery and to manage the energy discharged from the battery to supply electrical energy to the one or more microgrids.

(8) Other technical features may be readily apparent to one skilled in the art from the following figures, descriptions, and claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) For a more complete understanding of this disclosure, reference is now made to the following description, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which:

- (2) FIG. 1 is a diagram schematically illustrating the multi-level control system for the battery energy storage system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (3) FIG. 2 is diagram schematically illustrating the communication networks and features of the battery energy storage system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (4) FIG. 3 is diagram schematically illustrating the battery energy storage system container, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure; and
- (5) FIG. 4 is diagram schematically illustrating the electronic control system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(6) The figures, discussed below, and the various embodiments used to describe the principles of the present invention in this patent document are by way of illustration only and should not be construed in any way to limit the scope of the invention. Those skilled in the art will understand that the principles of the invention may be implemented in any type of suitably arranged device or system.

(7) A multi-level control system is disclosed for controlling a battery energy storage system (BESS). As illustrated in FIGS. 1 and 2, the BESS is comprised of a multi-level control system **100** consisting of four hierarchical levels. At the first level, a BESS unit controller **110** is located in a BESS container **120**. The BESS unit controller **110** is used to control the functions of a BESS container **120** and its power conversion assets. Each BESS container **120** is organized as a self-contained package that may at least include a power conversion system, a battery system, a heating ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) system, fire protection systems and components and sensors required to monitor the BESS container **120**. Each BESS container **120** can be used to power stand-alone deployments of the BESS **100** such as for example, a building or a business enterprise or microgrid deployments where a single BESS container **120** or multiple BESS containers **120** can provide power to a neighborhood of homes or to a business district.

(8) At the second level an energy control system (ECS) **130** is communicatively coupled to one or more BESS unit controllers **110**, **110'**. The ECS **130** including a BESS ECS controller **135** that controls the operation of one or more BESS containers **120**. The ECS **130** is comprised of a BESS ECS controller **135** and a microgrid ECS (MECS) controller **140**. The ECS **130** may be connected to stand-alone BESS container **120** deployments or multiple BESS container **120** deployments or to grid connected multi-container BESS deployments. For example, in FIG. 1, the ECS **130** is shown connected to both BESS unit controller **110**, as well as BESS unit controller **110'** of BESS container **120'**.

(9) The MECS controller **140** comprises the third level of the BESS control system **100**. The MECS controller **140** is communicatively coupled to the BESS ECS controller **135** and manages alternate power generation assets such as for example, solar, wind, hydroelectric power that may be connected and available on the grid for use by the BESS container **120**. The BESS MECS controller **140** is arranged to provide the alternate power capabilities to either a stand-alone BESS container **120** deployment or to multiple microgrid connected BESS container deployments.

(10) Level 4 of the BESS control system **100** includes a virtual power plant (VPP) **160**. The VPP **160** is comprised of distributed small and medium-scale power generating units, loads and energy storage systems, that when aggregated and coordinated using software, performs functions equivalent to a centralized physical power plant. A software operating program executing on, for example a server **162**, functions as a controller that controls the VPP **160**. The VPP **160** further includes an operator station **164** and an interface to the cloud **168**. The server **162** may be any device that provides resources, data, services or software programs to other processing devices or clients over a network. The operator station **164** may be any computing device that provides functions for power plant operations and monitoring including display of graphics such as diagrams, systems, BESS container **120** deployments and data to a user or operator. The operator station **164** may also receive input from the user or operator to adjust or enter configurable

parameters for the BESS unit controller **120**, BESS ECS controller **135** and the MECS controller **140**. The cloud **168** may be any computing device or technology that delivers services through the internet, including, information, data storage, servers, access to databases, networking, and software. The VPP **160** can control multiple BESS containers **120** connected to the VPP **160** through a communication network **108**. The VPP **160** as shown in FIG. 1 controls BESS containers **120**, **120'** in multigrid deployments such as the microgrid **1** and microgrid **2** illustrated in FIG. 1.

(11) With reference to FIG. 2, the communication features of the BESS unit container **120** are illustrated. Each BESS container **120** further includes communication interfaces that operate using for example an Ethernet communication protocol to communicate between the various components of BESS container **120** and to other BESS containers communicatively coupled to each other in multi-container deployments as for example, between BESS container **120** and **120'**. The BESS unit container **120** connects to the VPP **160** and to server **162**, operator station **164** and cloud **168** via network switch **400**, firewall **220**, and network **108**. Communication between the BESS container **120** and VPP **160** is based on DNP3 protocol as used in supervisory control and data acquisition (SCADA) and remote monitoring systems. Network switching devices **200** contained in the BESS container **120** distribute control and data signals between the components of the BESS container **120** and to other interconnected BESS containers, such as for example BESS container **120'**. For example, network switch **200'** located in BESS container **120'** may receive control and data signal from the ECS **130** contained in BESS container **120**. The network switch **200** distributing the control and data signals from ECS **130** to BESS unit controller **110'** via network switch **200'** using network **109**. The BESS unit container **120** may also include a communication interface **210** that may connect to a wireless interface **230** allowing communication with the BESS unit controller **110** using a handheld mobile device **240**. The handheld mobile device **240** can be used to configure operating parameters of the BESS container **120**, and/or retrieve operating data, fault conditions and/or alarms and warnings from the BESS unit controller **110**. The BESS container **120** may also include other forms of communication interfaces such as for example, serial digital and analog I/O communication interfaces, which allow the BESS unit controller **110** to communicate and control BESS container **120** subsystems, sensors and components that will be explained in FIG. 3.

(12) The BESS unit controller **110** is tasked to provide for the safe and reliable operation of a BESS container **120**. The BESS unit controller **110** monitors the operation of a BESS container **120** preventing operations during fault conditions, shutting down a faulty subsystem and/or sending notifications and alarms to operator station **164** or to mobile device **240**. Alarms may be sent using different priority levels if a component, sensor, or subsystem of the BESS unit container **120** fails or becomes faulty. The BESS unit controller **110** interfaces with all the subsystems within a container such as a power conversion system, battery system, HVAC subsystems, fire protection systems etc. The major components of the BESS unit container **120** includes the BESS unit controller **110**, battery racks **305** housed within the BESS container **120**, a power container **310** housed on a separate transportable skid, and the ECS **130**.

(13) As shown in FIG. 3, the BESS unit controller **110** is comprised of at least one processor **301**, at least one memory device **310**, and at least one I/O interface **320**. The processor **301** executes instructions that may be loaded into memory **310**. The processor **301** may include any suitable number(s) and type(s) of processing or other devices in any suitable arrangement. Example types of processing devices include microprocessors, microcontrollers, digital signal processors, field programmable gate arrays, application specific integrated circuits, and discreet circuitry. The processor **301** executes the various programs that operates the various operating modes, states, and safety systems of the BESS container **120**.

(14) The memory **310** represents any structure(s) capable of storing and facilitating retrieval of information (such as data, program code, and/or other suitable information on a temporary or permanent basis). The memory **310** may represent a random access memory or any other suitable

volatile or non-volatile storage device(s). The memory may also include one or more components or devices supporting longer-term storage of data, such as a read only memory, hard drive, flash memory, or optical disc.

(15) The I/O interface supports communications with the other systems or devices contained in the BESS container **120**. For example, the communications interface **320** could include I/O modules and a network interface card that facilitates communications between the BESS unit controller **110** and the subsystems and sensors of the BESS container **120** as well to levels 2-4 of the BESS control system **100**. The I/O unit **320** may support communications through any suitable physical wired communication link or bus. For example, the I/O interface **320** may include an I/O module that can interface control signals to connected HVAC systems HVAC-1 and HVAC-2 through a comstat4 HVAC controller **350** using a serial digital output. The I/O interface **320** may also include an analog module that can receive 4-20 mA current loop signals from the various analog sensors located in the BESS container **120**, such as for example, temperature sensor **352**, air velocity sensor **354**, pressure sensor and transmitter **356** and the relative humidity (RH) sensor **358**. The I/O interface **320** also includes an Ethernet interface for bidirectional communication of control signals and data between a battery administration unit (BAU) **360**, the ECS **130** and the various fire safety devices such as the fire detection panel **362** and LiON-tamer **364** and gas detector **366**, that detects hydrogen gas that may be generated by lithium batteries as they degrade.

(16) As illustrated in FIG. 3, the BESS container **120** includes battery racks **305** that are organized as battery modules that are electrically interconnected in series and also in parallel. The battery modules are further organized as cells that are also electrically interconnected in series and also in parallel. The multiple battery modules form a battery rack and multiple battery racks **305** are stacked within the BESS container **120**. Charging and discharging of batteries in the battery racks **305** take into account the state of charge (SOC) of the battery modules and ensures that charging does not cause increased power dissipation and heating of the individual cells. Controlling charge profile based on SOC is typically a function provided by a battery management system (BMS) **310** associated with battery racks **305**.

(17) Each BESS container **120** is also connected to a power container **310** communicatively coupled to the BESS container **120**. The power container **310** typically includes a bidirectional power conversion system (PCS) **315** and its associated components. The PCS **315** converts an AC voltage supplied by the grid, to DC voltage to charge the battery racks **305** or converts the DC power provided by the battery racks **305** into an AC voltage providing electrical power to a connected building, dwellings or to a microgrid. The power container **310** may also include low tension (LT) switch gear **327** and transformer **319** to provide electrical power to low tension or low voltage electrical networks.

(18) The BESS unit controller **110** is further operatively connected to the BESS ECS controller **135**. The BESS ECS controller **135** acts as a supervisory controller to one or more BESS unit controllers **110**. As shown in FIGS. 1 and 2 an ECS **130** can control one or more BESS containers using the control network **109**. The BESS unit controller **110** of each BESS container **120** gathers the operating parameters of a connected BESS unit **120** and sends the data to its supervising BESS ECS controller **135** for control of the charging and discharging requirements of the BESS container(s) **120**. For example, BESS ECS controller **135** computes the power reference for each PCS **315** attached to one or more BESS container **120**, taking into account the current operational state of a BESS container **120**, such as alarms related to failure of subsystems or faults and diagnostics data of critical subsystems, such as the battery racks **305**, PCS **315** and HVAC.

(19) When multiple BESS containers **120** and their power containers **310** are used at any site to provide electrical power at a stand-alone site or microgrid, the BESS ECS controller **135** determines the total charging power or discharging power that should be provided to the deployment and distributes the charging or discharging power requirements to the connected multiple BESS unit controllers **110**. For example, the BESS ECS controller **135** computes a power

reference for the different PCS 315 units, considering the power capacity of each PCS 315 and the power and energy capacity of the BESS container 120. Power and energy capacity of the BESS container 120 is determined by the number of battery racks 305 in operation. When there are multiple BESS containers 120 deployed at stand-alone site, or at a microgrid site, and the multiple BESS containers 120 are connected to a single PCS 315, the deployment however having a capability of more than a single PCSs 315, then the BESS ECS controller 135 computes power reference for all the PCSs 315 that are available to be connected. The BESS ECS controller 135 communicates the state of the plurality of BESS containers 120 to the next level in the BESS control hierarchy, the MECS controller 140. The BESS ECS controller 135 also communicates the available power reference for a PCS 315 to the BESS unit controller 135, associated and connected to a BESS container 120.

(20) In installations having multiple BESS containers 120 the balancing state of the battery racks 305 for one BESS container 120 with the battery racks of another BESS container is not taken in account by either the BMS 310 of each battery racks 305 or the battery administration unit 360 of the BESS container 120. In such multiple BESS container 120 installations the BESS ECS controller 135 manages each battery administration unit (BAU) 360 of a BESS container 120 through its respective BESS unit controller 110, via network switch 200. The ECS controller 135 provides a state of charge (SOC) balancing through the BAU 360 to the BMS 310 of each of the battery racks 305 of the multiple connected BESS containers 120.

(21) Additionally, the BESS ECS controller 135 is arranged to consider the microgrid loads that the BESS container 120 needs to power and manages the available power containers 310 to draw sufficient power from the battery racks 305 of each BESS container 120 so as not to over-discharge anyone of the battery racks 305. When multiple BESS containers 120 and PCS 315 are used at any deployment site, the BESS ECS controller 135 is further arranged to determine the total charging power or discharging power for the multiple BESS containers 120. The BESS ECS controller 135 controls the distribution of the charging power to the multiple BAU units 360 and their associated battery racks 305 to the multiple BESS power containers 310.

(22) With reference to FIG. 4, the components of the ECS 130 are illustrated. The ECS 130 is comprised of the BESS ECS controller 135 and the MECS controller 140. The BESS ECS controller 135 and the MECS controller 140 are logically separate, however, they may be located on and execute within a common physical hardware/software controller or communicatively coupled to different physical hardware/software controllers. As shown in FIG. 4, the BESS ECS controller 135 is comprised of at least one processor 401, at least one memory device 410, at least one ECS server interface 415 and a least one MODBUS TCP interface 420. The processor 401 executes instructions that may be loaded into memory 410. The processor 401 may include any suitable number(s) and type(s) of processing or other devices in any suitable arrangement. Example types of processing devices include microprocessors, microcontrollers, digital signal processors, field programmable gate arrays, application specific integrated circuits, and discreet circuitry.

(23) The memory 410 represents any structure(s) capable of storing and facilitating retrieval of information (such as data, program code, and/or other suitable information on a temporary or permanent basis). The memory 410 may represent a random access memory or any other suitable volatile or non-volatile storage device(s). The memory may also include one or more components or devices supporting longer-term storage of data, such as a read only memory, hard drive, flash memory, or optical disc.

(24) The processor 401 executes the various programs stored in memory 410 that operates the BESS ECS controller 135 to provide references for power balancing between BESS containers 120 and the PCS 315 attached to the BESS containers 120. The programs further operate to distribute the power balancing references to the BESS unit controllers 110. The BESS ECS controller 135 also takes inputs on the number of battery racks 305 that have been committed within a BESS container 120 in the calculation of power reference for the BESS containers 120. The BESS ECS

controller **135** executes programs that calculate energy balancing taking into consideration the aggregate SOC and cycle count of different BESS containers **120** that have the same or a different number of battery racks **305** available for discharge or cut-out and not available for use.

(25) The ECS server interface **415** provides a communication portal to network **108** through network switch **400** and firewall **220** to the VPP **160** using a DPN3 protocol. This communication portal from server interface **415** serves as the BESS container **120** connection to VPP **160** and level 4 of the BESS control system **100**. As is seen in FIG. 4, the MECS controller **140** also includes a direct communication connection to the ECS server interface **415** through a bidirectional line **401** that allows the MECS controller **140** to have direct access to the VPP **160**. The MECS controller **140** can be located and contained in the ECS **130**, however, as explained above, it is logically separate from the BESS ECS controller **135**.

(26) The MODBUS TCP interface provides a Modbus TCP/IP communication portal providing Ethernet intranet communication between the BESS ECS controller **135** and BESS unit controllers **110** in either single or multiple BESS container **120** deployments using network switch **200**.

(27) The ECS **130** functions as an DNP3 outstation that interworks with a DNP3 master running on server **162** on the VPP **160**. The BESS ECS controller **135** allows selection of four different operating modes to provide power reference for connected BESS unit controllers **110**. These include: (1) a configurable power reference configured for a configurable duration of test (this mode is used mostly for test and certifications; (2) a local human machine interface (HMI) configuration of a schedule for charging or discharging according to a power reference configured to the BESS ECS controller **135**, from for example, the operator station **164** or the handheld mobile device **240**; (3) a local HMI configuration of use cases that the battery rack **305** needs to support and a configurable schedule for the use cases of the HMI configuration; and (4) a download of BESS charge/discharge schedule from a remote operation center from the cloud **168**. Operating mode 3 enables operation of the BESS control system **100** within a microgrid, where function blocks running algorithms for each of the use cases generates a power reference for the PCS **315** to handle charging or discharging of the battery racks **305** contained in the BESS container **120**.

(28) As illustrated in FIG. 4, the VPP **160** is directly connected to the MECS controller **140** of each ECS **130**. The VPP **160** performing centralized co-ordination of distributed microgrids. The VPP **160** is tasked to calculate reference power for either supplying power to the microgrid or drawing power from a main grid to which multiple microgrids are connected. The MECS controller **140** can also receive an operating schedule from the VPP **160**. For example, a schedule for the exchange of power between a microgrid and the grid, or a schedule of grid electricity prices associated with power import or export in situations where the import and export of power has a difference in a price setpoint, or simply a schedule of use cases for which one or more BESS containers **120** along with generation assets and loads are to be committed. For example, renewable smoothing for export between 09:00 and 12:00 hours, and frequency regulation support between 12:00 and 17:00 hours and grid peak demand support between 17:00 and 20:00 hours.

(29) With information from the VPP **160**, the MECS controller **140** computes a schedule for charging or discharging one or more BESS containers **120**. The MECS controller **140** computing the schedule for charging or discharging, taking into account, the schedule provided by the VPP **160**, but also the local generation loads, frequency and voltage within a microgrid.

(30) When computing schedules the MECS controller **140** uses look ahead operations, to forecast local power generation and demand/loads. When local power generation is controllable, such as for example using a diesel generator, the forecast of such generation is same as the schedule for commitment of controllable generators. When power generation is not controllable, and are variable and intermittent in nature, such as using renewable power generation sources, a forecast is computed using historic time series data as well as inputs from weather stations and other sources of weather forecast provided by the VPP **160**. If there is a deviation, then the deviation needs to be accounted for and the schedules revised. For example, in a look ahead operation that uses a

forecast, a short-term accurate forecast is necessary because charging or discharging a battery takes a finite amount of time and depends on the rate at which level the battery is providing energy or its C-Rating. For instance, it takes approximately 1 hour to fully charge a 1 C rated battery system while it takes 4 hours to fully charge or discharge a 0.25 C rated battery system. Hence for a 0.25 C rated battery system, in order to meet a grid peak support use case at any given time, battery charging should have started at least four hours before the time at which battery is intended to be discharged using PCS **315**. Even for a 1 C rated system, where it is feasible to charge with high power, but charging with a higher power may attract higher demand charges, or alternatively may cause a larger rise in battery temperature that can cause it to degrade faster, it may be necessary to charge with a lower power. A lower charging power would mean charging for a longer duration and a forecast for at least that duration is necessary to ensure battery is charged when it is required to discharge the stored energy.

(31) The VPP **160** is further tasked in the balancing of the supply and demand for power in multiple microgrids using economic optimization objectives, peak demand forecasts and renewable energy generation forecasts. For example, the VPP **160** may receive information from the cloud **168** from energy trading data that generates market bids and market clearing prices from an energy market operator. The information used on demand as information response signals to the MECS controller **140** to reduce use of diesel electrical generating sources over other generating sources due to the higher costs of diesel fuel.

(32) The VPP **160** may execute standard equipment templates for all distributed energy resources that are managed within a microgrid. For every distributed energy resource managed by the VPP **160** a standard equipment template is maintained by the VPP **160** software. Each BESS ECS controller **135** maintains a library of object models in memory **410** for different types of distributed energy resources associated with a BESS unit container **120**. For example, the BESS ECS controller **135** may contain a battery container object model for a BESS container **120**, describing how the battery cells of a battery module are arranged, the number of battery modules stacked to form a battery rack **305**, and the number of battery racks **305** installed within the BESS container **120**.

(33) The BESS ECS controller **135** may also contain a meter object model stored in memory **410** used for modeling banks of loads that are behind a multifunction meter. The BESS ECS controller **135** may also include an environment object model used for monitoring the environmental parameters, such as for example, temperature, pressure, relative humidity within a BESS unit container **120** and a safety system object model used for modeling safety critical safety parameters of a BESS container **120**.

(34) The BESS unit controller **110** has 2 operational modes: 1. A normal operation mode consisting of: 1.1 a Grid Connected Mode; 1.2 a Backup/Islanded Mode; and 2. an Engineering Mode,

(35) In operational modes 1 and 2 the BESS unit controller **110** can have up to eleven different operational states: a. a Startup State; b. a Ready State; c. a Charging State; d. a Discharging State; e. a Restricted Charge Only State; f. a Restricted Discharge Only State; g. a Long Term Shutdown State; h. a Selective Shutdown State; i. an ESTOP TRIP State; j. a FIRE TRIP State; and k. an Idle State.

(36) In the Grid Connected Mode of operation the PCS **315** synchronizes to the grid frequency and follows the grid voltage. The voltage output is not determined by the PCS **315** but rather it follows the grid voltage. An inverter associated with PCS **315** sources current so that output power produced matches the power reference that is calculated by the BESS ECS controller **135** and provided to the PCS **315** via the BESS unit controller **110**. In this mode of operation, the inverter can produce the same output power on all three phases and hence the loads on all three phases are balanced. Any imbalance would be resolved by power drawn from the grid or other generators for phases that have higher loads than the phase with a minimum load. If the power reference is negative, then the PCS **315** will charge the battery with power drawn from grid or an alternate

source of power selected by the MCES controller **140**. Charging power is calculated by the BESS ECS controller **135**, taking into consideration the total generation within a microgrid to be served, total loads within the microgrid and constraints on power that can be drawn from the grid.

(37) The Backup/Island mode of operation is entered when a grid failure is detected by BESS ECS controller **135**. In this mode of operation, PCS **315** produces an AC output voltage and frequency that is determined by a PCS configuration for no load voltage and frequency by the BESS unit controller **110**. This configuration of no load voltage and frequency may also be changed when the BESS unit controller **110** is commanded by BESS ECS controller **135** to change the voltage and frequency. The voltage output and frequency are determined by an inverter device associated with the PCS **315**, not by any other generator that may be sharing a load with PCS **315**. The inverter supports the microgrid voltage when in the Islanded Mode so that output power produced matches the power reference that is calculated by the ECS controller **135**. In this mode of operation, the PCS **315** can produce a different output power on three phases of AC and the current on each phase depends on the loads connected to that phase. If the power reference is negative, then the PCS **315** will charge the battery **305** with power drawn from alternate sources selected by the BESS MCES **140**. Charging power is calculated by BESS ECS controller **135**, taking into consideration the total generation within a microgrid and total loads within the microgrid.

(38) The Engineering Mode of operation is meant for use by maintenance engineers for the purpose of test, repair, and maintenance, including the replacement of faulty parts or subsystems, and to test the BESS container **120**, and ECS **130** before putting the system back in normal operation. It can also be used during installation and commissioning of a BESS container **120**. In the Engineering Mode of operation, the BESS unit controller **110** ignores power reference for the PCS **315** from the BESS ECS controller **135**. Instead, it takes a fixed power reference for both active and reactive power that a user may configure using an HMI entered into the operator station **164** or the mobile device **240**. The BESS container **120** may enter into restricted charging or discharging mode of operation only if load thresholds are reached.

(39) The Startup State is the first state after the BESS unit controller **110** is powered on and the BESS unit controller **110** program is executed by the processor **310**. Upon startup the connections to the various subsystems and components of the BESS container **120** are tested. Such as for example, HVAC-1, HVAC-2, LT switch gear **317**, PCS **315**, BAU **360**, etc. If the connection tests fail, the system will wait for a configurable duration of time, before repeating the connection tests. If connection tests fail again the startup is aborted and system waits until the connection alarms are cleared.

(40) The ready state is reached, if there are no connection errors to and from any of the BESS container **120** subsystems, and when an operator configures system to come up in normal operation mode, if there are no high alarms, such as for example, a hydrogen gas detector **366** failure or a battery temperature alarm from the BMS **310**. In the ready state, the BESS unit controller **110** waits for command from the BESS ECS controller **135** to start the PCS **315** and the BMS **310**.

(41) The Charging State or the Discharging State is entered after the ready state is reached. The BESS ECS controller **135** or BESS unit controller **110** (in engineering mode) commands the PCS **315** to charge the battery **305** with a negative power reference. In the Discharge State the BESS ECS controller **135** or BESS unit controller **110** (in engineering mode) commands the PCS **315** to discharge the battery **305** with a positive power reference.

(42) The BESS **100** enters the Restricted Charge Only State when battery **305** is deep discharged, and a low SOC limit is reached. Two low thresholds L1 and L2 ($L1 < L2$) are configurable by the user using the HMI running on the operator station **164** or mobile device **240**. The BESS unit controller **110** goes into the Restricted Charge Only State when the L1 threshold is reached and remains in this state until it charges up and the L2 threshold is reached. After the L2 threshold is reached, it comes back to either a normal or an engineering mode of operation and continues in that mode. A typical value for L1 is 20% of the battery rack **305** SOC and a typical value for L2 is 50%

of the battery rack **305** SOC. The value of L1 should be higher than the SOC low threshold set by the BMS **310** so that BMS **310** does not go into the restricted mode of operation not under the control of BESS unit controller **110**. These thresholds can be changed by a user using the HMI as described above. When the BESS unit controller **110** is in the Restricted Charge Only State, a positive power reference for the PCS **315** from ECS controller **135** is ignored by the BESS unit controller **110** and replaced with zero power reference. A negative power reference from BESS ECS controller **135** is passed to the PCS **315** for charging the battery **305**.

(43) The BESS unit controller **110** is in a Restricted Discharge Only State when the battery **305** is fully charged and a high SOC limit is reached. Two high thresholds H1 and H2 ($H1 > H2$) are configurable from the HMI. The BESS unit controller **110** goes into the Restricted Discharge Only State when an H1 threshold is reached and remains in this state until it is discharged down to and reaches the H2 threshold. After the H2 threshold is reached, it comes back to either the normal or engineering mode of operation and continues in that mode. A typical value for H1 is 95% of the battery rack **305** SOC and a typical value for H2 is 50% of the battery rack **305** SOC. The value of H1 is set lower than the SOC high threshold for BMS **310** so that BMS **310** does not go into the restricted state of operation that is not under the control of BESS unit controller **110**. When BESS is in the Restricted Discharge Only State, a negative power reference for the PCS **315** from the BESS ECS controller **135** is ignored by the BESS unit controller **110** and replaced with a zero power reference. A positive power reference from the BESS ECS controller **135** is passed to the PCS **315** for discharging the battery rack **305**.

(44) In the Standby State the BESS unit controller **110** will be in an idle state with zero power reference to the PCS **315** and disconnected from battery (DC side) and grid (AC side). In the Standby State PCS **315** is not modulating. The standby state is entered when alarms are low on a priority list, which do not require a complete shut-down of BESS container **120**. The standby state can also be entered when continued charging or discharging of the battery **305** can lead to faults that may trigger higher priority alarms. When in the standby state, the PCS **315** can come out of the standby state and go to the Grid Connected Mode of operation when alarms are cleared in less than 10 seconds of their occurrence.

(45) In the Graceful Shutdown State the BESS container **120** subsystems are shut down and the BESS unit controller **110** is halted. PCS **315** is disconnected from the battery **305**. The Graceful Shutdown State is entered when high priority alarms are being sent from the BESS container **120** subsystems that are of high priority and which do not require a trip of BESS unit controller **110**. Additionally, This state may be entered when continued operation of BESS unit controller **110** could lead to faults that may trigger higher priority alarms. All BESS container **120** subsystems including the HVAC-1, HVAC-2 subsystems are shut down. Examples of conditions that would trigger a Graceful Shutdown State of are when a pre-fire alarm is raised by the fire panel **362** or when the BESS unit container **120** internal RH sensor **358** raises an alarm. When in Graceful Shutdown state, the BESS unit controller **110** can only return to a normal operation mode by an operator intervention.

(46) In the Long Term Shutdown State the BESS container **120** is shut down for a long duration. Battery **305** SOC should be within the specified range for long term shutdown. The long term storage charge for lithium batteries, is typically 30% of their SOC.

(47) The Selective Shutdown option is used when individual subsystems are selectively shutdown, due to faults or for maintenance purpose.

(48) In the ESTOP Trip State the BESS container **120** subsystems will disconnected from the grid and the battery **305** and program execution by the BESS unit controller **110** will halt. The PCS **315** is also disconnected from battery **305** and ceases to modulate. The ESTOP Trip State is entered when high priority alarms are encountered, that do not allow time for a graceful shut down of the BESS container **120** subsystems, and when continued operation of the BESS container **120** can lead to damages to BESS control system **100**. HVAC-1 and HVAC-2 systems are also turned off in

the ESTOP Trip State. The ESTOP Trip State may be triggered when for example, the BAU 360 trips and is disconnected from PCS 315 or when an internal temperature alarm is raised when the BESS container 120 experiences a thermal run away. The BESS container 120 can be reset to a normal operation only on an operator intervention.

(49) In Fire Trip state the BESS container 120 is disconnected from the grid and the battery 305 and execution of the BESS unit controller 110 will halt. The PCS 315 is disconnected from the battery 305 and the PCS 315 ceases to modulate. The Fire Trip State is entered when fire alarms are encountered, which do not allow time for a graceful shut down of the BESS container 120 subsystems, and when continued operation of BESS container 120 and HVAC-1 and HVAC-2 can cause safety hazards for fire-fighting personnel. HVAC-1 and HVCA-2 and auxiliary power supplies are taken off-line and the entire BESS container 120 including the BESS unit controller 110 and BESS ECS controller 135 are shut-down. The BESS container 120 can only be reset to a normal operation only on an operator intervention.

(50) In the Idle State the BESS ECS controller 135 or the BESS unit controller 110 (in engineering mode) commands the PCS 315 to neither charge nor discharge the battery 305 by sending a zero power reference command.

(51) It may be advantageous to set forth definitions of certain words and phrases used throughout this patent document. The term “communicate,” as well as derivatives thereof, encompasses both direct and indirect communication. The terms “include” and “comprise,” as well as derivatives thereof, mean inclusion without limitation. The term “or” is inclusive, meaning and/or. The phrase “associated with,” as well as derivatives thereof, may mean to include, be included within, interconnect with, contain, be contained within, connect to or with, couple to or with, be communicable with, cooperate with, interleave, juxtapose, be proximate to, be bound to or with, have, have a property of, have a relationship to or with, or the like. The phrase “at least one of,” when used with a list of items, means that different combinations of one or more of the listed items may be used, and only one item in the list may be needed. For example, “at least one of: A, B, and C” includes any of the following combinations: A, B, C, A and B, A and C, B and C, and A and B and C.

(52) The description in the present application should not be read as implying that any particular element, step, or function is an essential or critical element that must be included in the claim scope. The scope of patented subject matter is defined only by the allowed claims. Moreover, none of the claims is intended to invoke 35 U.S.C. § 112(f) with respect to any of the appended claims or claim elements unless the exact words “means for” or “step for” are explicitly used in the particular claim, followed by a participle phrase identifying a function. Use of terms such as (but not limited to) “mechanism,” “module,” “device,” “unit,” “component,” “element,” “member,” “apparatus,” “machine,” “system,” or “controller” within a claim is understood and intended to refer to structures known to those skilled in the relevant art, as further modified or enhanced by the features of the claims themselves and is not intended to invoke 35 U.S.C. § 112(f).

(53) While this disclosure has described certain embodiments and generally associated methods, alterations and permutations of these embodiments and methods will be apparent to those skilled in the art. Accordingly, the above description of example embodiments does not define or constrain this disclosure. Other changes, substitutions, and alterations are also possible without departing from the spirit and scope of this disclosure, as defined by the following claims.

Claims

1. A battery energy storage system for receiving energy from an electrical grid and for supplying electrical energy to one or more microgrids, the battery energy storage system comprising: a virtual power plant system that receives an information concerning an electrical energy generation and an alternate sources of power asset available on the electrical grid; a plurality of containers, wherein

the container comprises: a battery associated with the container; and a power conversion system arranged to charge the battery with the energy from the electrical grid and discharge the battery to supply electrical energy to one or more microgrids, wherein the power conversion system comprises of: an energy control system controller communicatively coupled to the power conversion system for managing the energy drawn from the electrical grid to charge the battery and manage the energy discharged from the battery to supply electrical energy to the one or more microgrids, a container unit controller that is communicatively coupled to the energy control system controller and configured to control one or more functions of the power conversion system and the battery, wherein the energy control system controller uses an alternate power asset to charge the battery; and a microgrid energy control system controller communicatively coupled to the virtual power plant system and the energy control system controller, wherein the virtual power plant system provides information of the alternate power asset available on the electrical grid to the microgrid energy control system controller and the microgrid energy control system controller is arranged to provide the information to the energy control system controller of the alternate power asset available on the electrical grid.

2. The battery energy storage system of claim 1, wherein the battery energy storage system further includes: a container associated with the battery and the power conversion system, the container containing the container unit controller communicatively coupled to the battery and the power conversion system and to the energy control system controller; and the container unit controller communicating a status information from the battery and the power conversion system to the energy control system controller and arranged to receive instructions from the energy control system controller to operate the power conversion system to charge or discharge the battery.

3. The battery energy storage system of claim 1, wherein the energy control system controller considers an amount of power required to be supplied to the electrical grid and is arranged to instruct the container unit controller of the container to discharge the battery so as to not over-discharge the battery.

4. The battery energy storage system of claim 3, wherein the energy control system controller considers the amount of power available on the electrical grid and instructs the container unit controller to charge the battery so as to not overcharge the battery.

5. The battery energy storage system of claim 1, wherein the virtual power plant system includes: a communication network connected to the virtual power plant system and the microgrid energy control system controller; a server connected to the communication network, the server executing a virtual power plant controller; an operator station connected to the communication network for entering and receiving information from the communication network; and an interface to a cloud for receiving information from an internet.

6. The battery energy storage system of claim 1, wherein the container includes a wireless interface connected to the energy control system controller and the container unit controller.

7. The battery energy storage system of claim 6, wherein the wireless interface is arranged to send signals to a handheld mobile device.

8. The battery energy storage system of claim 6, wherein the container unit controller monitors an operation of the battery and the power conversion system of the container and prevents operation during fault conditions, shutting down the power conversion system and sending alarms on a communication network to an operator station or the wireless interface to an handheld mobile device.

9. An apparatus for receiving energy from an electrical grid and for supplying electrical energy to one or more microgrids, the apparatus comprising: an energy control system processor, an energy control system memory coupled to the energy control system processor; a virtual power plant system that receives an information concerning an electrical energy generation and an alternate sources of power assets available on the electrical grid; a plurality of containers, wherein the container comprises: a battery associated with the container; and a power conversion system,

arranged to charge the battery with the energy from the electrical grid and discharge the battery to supply electrical energy to one or more microgrids, wherein the power conversion system comprises of: an energy control system controller stored in the energy control system memory and executed by the energy control system processor for managing the energy drawn from the electrical grid to charge the battery and manage the energy discharged from the battery to supply electrical energy to the one or more microgrids, a container unit controller that is communicatively coupled to the energy control system controller and configured to control one or more functions of the power conversion system and the battery associated with the container, wherein the energy control system controller uses the alternate power asset to charge the battery; and a microgrid energy control system controller communicatively coupled to the virtual power plant system and the energy control system controller, wherein the virtual power plant system provides information for the alternate power asset available on the electrical grid to the microgrid energy control system controller and the microgrid energy control system controller is arranged to provide the information to the energy control system controller of the alternate power asset available on the electrical grid.

10. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein: the apparatus further includes: a container associated with the battery and the power conversion system, a container unit processor; a container unit memory coupled to the processor; the processor communicatively coupled to the battery and the power conversion system and to the energy control system controller; and the container unit controller stored in the container unit memory and executed by the container unit processor that communicates status information from the battery and the power conversion system to the energy control system controller and arranged to receive instructions from the energy control system controller to operate the power conversion system to charge or discharge the battery.

11. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the container unit processor executing the container unit controller to communicatively couple to the battery and the power conversion system associated with the container of the plurality of containers and to the energy control system controller, the container unit controller communicating status information from the battery and the power conversion system associated with the container to the energy control system controller and arranged to receive instructions from the energy control system controller to operate the power conversion system to charge or discharge the battery.

12. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the energy control system controller is executed by the energy control system processor to consider an amount of power required to be supplied to the electrical grid and arranged to instruct the container unit controller of the container to discharge the battery so as to not over-discharge any one of the battery.

13. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the energy control system controller is executed by the processor to consider an amount of power available on the electrical grid and arranged to instruct the unit controller of the container to charge the battery so as to not over-charge any one of the battery.

14. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the apparatus further includes: a communication network connected to the virtual power plant system and the microgrid energy control system controller; a server connected to the communication network, the server executing a virtual power plant controller; an operator station connected to the communication network for entering and receiving information from the communication network; and an interface to a cloud for receiving the information from an internet.

15. The apparatus claim 14, wherein the container includes a wireless interface connected to the energy control system controller and the container unit controller.

16. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the wireless interface is arranged to send signals to a handheld mobile device.

17. The apparatus of claim 16, wherein the container unit controller is operated by the container unit processor to monitor the operation of the battery and the power conversion system of the container and prevent operations during fault conditions, shutting down the power conversion

system and sending alarms on the communication network to the operator station or the wireless interface to the handheld mobile device.
